

Building Your Network

Weaving useful bonds, without pretending

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Weaving useful bonds, without pretending

‘Networking’ can feel self-serving or intimidating — especially if you dislike ‘selling yourself’. Yet networking is simply creating and maintaining sincere relationships that, one day, help each other.

This guide helps you move past what blocks you, see networking as sincere bonds, and weave it — even as an introvert.

Your intention

What holds you back or is missing in your network: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What blocks you

Fear of bothering, the sense that 'asking = taking advantage', shyness, or the idea that networking is 'fake': these brakes often come from a relationship to asking learned early.

Spotting them means no longer cutting yourself off from opportunities on principle.

Example

Sure networking was 'hypocritical', Marc isolated himself. Seeing it as sincere mutual help changed everything.

My block

What holds you back from making professional bonds? Where does the brake come from?

My view of networking

Write what 'networking' evokes for you — then a fairer view (mutual-help relationships).

→ *Networking isn't 'fake' — it's sincere mutual help.*

The thoughts that isolate

‘I have nothing to offer’, ‘they’ll find me self-serving’, ‘I won’t know what to say’: these thoughts stop you from reaching out.

Softening them makes the first step possible.

Example

Sure she’d ‘bother’ her, Nia just asked an expert a sincere question. She gladly answered.

Networking journal

Note: the thought that holds you back · a fairer version.

What I have to offer

List 3 things you can bring to others (help, an introduction, a perspective).

→ *I have things to offer too — networking works both ways.*

Networking as sincere relationships

Healthy networking means being sincerely interested in others and giving before receiving. No calculation: curiosity and mutual help, which create lasting bonds.

The best professional relationships are born of genuine interest.

Example

By helping first with no expectation, Léa wove a network that, naturally, opened doors later.

Give first

Whom could you help or be useful to this week, with no expectation?

Sincere curiosity

Note 2 people whose path genuinely interests you — and a question to ask them.

→ *Giving and being sincerely interested — that's networking.*

Weaving & maintaining

Concretely: map your current network, dare a simple first contact, maintain it (a message now and then, not only when you need something), and use events/LinkedIn — adapted if you're an introvert (1-1, writing).

A regularly maintained network is there when you need it.

Example

By reconnecting with 'dormant' former colleagues, Sofia reactivated a valuable network without 'forcing' it.

My mapping

List 5 people (current or 'dormant') to (re)contact + why.

Maintaining the bond

Pick a sustainable rhythm (e.g. 1 sincere message/week) and your intro/extra version.

→ *Weaving and maintaining regularly — that's what makes a solid network.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Networking = sincere relationships, not calculation.
- Give before you ask (help, an introduction, sincere interest).
- Maintain the bond: a message now and then, not only when you need something.
- Dare a simple first contact (a question, a sincere compliment).
- Introvert? Favor 1-1 and writing, reconnect with 'dormant' bonds.
- Note who recommends you, and thank/return the favor.

To fill in

My mapping

Person to (re)contact	Why / how

Give first

Whom I can help	How

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Spot what blocks me.

Week 2 — Soften the thoughts that isolate.

Week 3 — See networking as sincere relationships.

Week 4 — Weave & maintain (my way).

Your plan in 3 lines

- The person I (re)contact first:
- What I can offer first:
- My rhythm for maintaining bonds:

TO CLOSE

Sincere relationships that help each other — that's networking.

Sincere relationships that help each other.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.